LaRoyce Jermaine Covington, Jr.

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Education

University of South Florida — **Tampa, FL**
Bachelor of Science *in Information Studies: Data Science and Analytics* — *Jun. 2017 – Dec. 2020*
Bachelor of Arts *in Political Science (Minor: Intelligence Studies)* — **GPA: 3.72**

Research

Big Data Analytics Lab — **School of Information, University of South Florida**
Undergraduate Research Assistant — *Jan. 2019 - Aug. 2020*

- Assisting Dr. Loni Hagen in original research in social network analytics and crisis communication.
- Conducted data collection and exploratory data analysis of social media texts.

Capstone Project — **School of Information, University of South Florida**
Automatic Summarization of Legislative Documents — A Survey — *Jan. 2020 - Apr. 2020*

- Conducted a content analysis on the use automatic summarization algorithms on legislation.
- Delivered a 2000-word essay and poster presentation on the findings.

Presentations

University of South Florida Information Day — **School of Information, University of South Florida**
Automatic Summarization of Legal Texts (poster) — *Apr. 2020 (cancelled, COVID-19)*

Honors and Awards

Pi Sigma Alpha, the Political Science Honor Society — *Apr. 2019 - present*
Florida Bright Futures scholarship, full undergraduate tuition — *May 2017 - present*

Classwork and Projects

rougeR — `www.github.com/LJCovingtonJr/rougeR`
An R Package for Automatic Evaluation of Summaries — *Apr. 2020*

- An R implementation of Lin (2004), *ROUGE: A Package for Automatic Evaluation of Summaries*.
- Currently supports ROUGE-N and -S for both single and multiple reference summaries
- Technologies used: R, including tokenizers package.

SumBasicR — `www.github.com/LJCovingtonJr/SumBasicR`
Frequency Based Summarization Algorithm — *Apr. 2020*

- An R implementation of Nenkova and Vanderwende (2005), *The Impact of Frequency on Summarization*.
- Technologies used: R, including tokenizers and dplyr packages.

LIS 4805: Predictive Analytics — **University of South Florida**
Predicting College Rank — *Dec. 2019*

- Predicted graduation rate using university demographic and financial information using machine learning techniques
- Developed a fitted model that improved prediction accuracy.
- Technologies used: R, including caret (Classification and Regression Training) package.

LIS 4671: Intro to Data and Text Mining — **University of South Florida**
Airline Tweets Analysis — *Aug. 2019*

- Conducted a linguistic and geographic analysis of 14,640 "real air-flight related tweets" made in February 2015.
- Featured on course instructor's website at `http://bit.ly/LJC_Airline`.
- Technologies used: R, including packages dplyr, ggplot2, ggmap, and tm (text mining package).

Non-Academic Experience

University of South Florida **Tampa, FL, USA**
Resident Assistant *Aug. 2018 - May 2019*

- Supervised a floor of 46 residents.
- Utilized organizational and public speaking skills to create and present hall programs to implement a multi-faceted residential curriculum.
- Researched and developed creative means to engage international students.

U.S. Embassy Ottawa **Remote**
Research Intern *Sept. 2018 - Apr. 2019*

- Researched areas of interest for the Embassy on military capabilities, trafficking in persons, and cannabis legalization; among other areas.
- Drafted regular reports used in the decision-making process.

University of South Florida Student Government **Tampa, FL, USA**
Deputy Supervisor of Elections *Nov. 2017 - Apr. 2018*

- Developed marketing and programming events attended by more than 100 people.
- Drafted a transitional report that reviewed the current election procedures and discussed improvements.
- Served on the regulatory commission for campaigns for Student Senate and Student Body President.

Community Involvement

Florida High Schools Model United Nations **Orlando, FL, USA**
Staff Member *Jan. 2020 - present*

- Directing educational committees on humanitarian situations among high school and middle school students while teaching policy writing, consensus building, and technical research skills during the academic year at statewide conferences.
- Assisting in the development of information policies as the organization temporarily shifted to digital conferences.

Young Democratic Socialists of America at USF **Tampa, FL, USA**
Steering Committee Member *Aug. 2019 - Dec. 2020*

- Determining the priorities and order of business, including management of the club's general course and operations.
- Organizing grassroots activism and volunteering events.
- Administering elections for the 2020-21 Executive Board.

Chair, Electoral Working Group *Aug. 2019 - Dec. 2020*

- Distributing promotional campaign material to the public through tabling and canvassing events.
- Organizing "DSA at the DNC": a campaign encouraging local DSA members—including students—to run for delegate positions at the 2020 Democratic National Convention, Milwaukee.

President *Apr. 2018 - Apr. 2019*

- Presided over meetings, oversaw organizational functions, and acted as the primary University liaison.

USF-Nielsen Sunshine State Survey **Tampa, FL, USA**
Question Development Team *Jan. 2018 - May 2018*

- Drafted survey questions regarding congressional apportionment for inclusion in the 2018 Survey.
- Analyzed the results of the 2017 survey and developed informative media regarding said results and their impact.

Skills

Programming: R, SQL, Java, Python, C++, LaTeX
Microsoft Office: Excel, Word, PowerPoint
Google Suite: Sheets, Docs, Slides
Languages: English (Native proficiency), Spanish (Professional working proficiency)